Support cards

Use the cards with a partner or adult. One reads; one finds the clue and explains. Swap roles. Each learner keeps their own answer. All examples are invented.

Invented payslip

Pay line	Amount
Gross pay	£1000
Tax deduction	£100
NI deduction	£50
Net pay	£850

Pay period: one invented month. Employer: invented unnamed paper-pack workplace. These are arithmetic practice amounts, not real tax or NI rates. £1000 − £100 − £50 = £850. No personal payslip is needed.

Practice month A

Gross £1,000; tax £100; NI £50; net £850. What do the four labels mean, and do the supplied lines balance?

Practice month B

Gross £800; tax £80; NI £40. Find total deductions and net pay. Check the result.

Check slip

Gross £600; tax £60; NI £30; printed net £520. Does the arithmetic match? What would be a sensible next action?

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Model and response frames

The invented payslip shows gross pay of £1,000. Gross means before deductions. The tax line is £100 and the National Insurance or NI line is £50. These amounts are supplied for practice; we are not working out real tax or NI.

First add the two deductions: £100 + £50 = £150. Next subtract the total from gross pay: £1,000 - £150 = £850. The £850 net-pay line is the amount left in this example.

Check by adding the net pay and deductions: £850 + £150 = £1,000. This matches gross pay. A calculator, number line, place-value aid or exact scribe may help; explain what the labels mean in your own words.

If a payslip figure is unclear, a worker can keep the record and ask the person responsible for pay to explain that line privately. A matched sum checks arithmetic; it does not prove that real tax, NI or every payment is correct.

Pair steps

1. Use practice month A. One learner is the reader: point to gross pay, tax, NI and net pay and read each amount. The other is the checker: match each label to its meaning. Each learner records their own four labels in their book or usual response mode.

2. Together add tax and NI, then subtract the total from gross pay. The reader explains the first calculation; the checker explains the second. Check by adding back. Each learner keeps their own working; the pair does not submit one shared answer.

3. Swap roles for practice month B: gross pay £800; tax £80; NI £40; net pay is not supplied. Find total deductions, calculate net pay and use the add-back check. These are also invented practice values.

4. Each learner privately answers the hinge. Compare methods afterwards only if both agree. An adult can be the partner, or the learner can point, speak or use an aid.

Frames

The useful clue is…

I would… because…

I need to check… with…

My evidence shows… It does not show…

Private help

Use voice, writing, pointing, a usual aid, typing or an exact scribe. Read back and correct. Plan in any language. Ask a trusted adult privately; pass, pause and return with support. No personal work or family story is needed.

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